

Inha University in Tashkent

***Theme 12.* Uzbekistan's Relations with the Commonwealth of Independent States**

Tashkent – 2024

Outline:



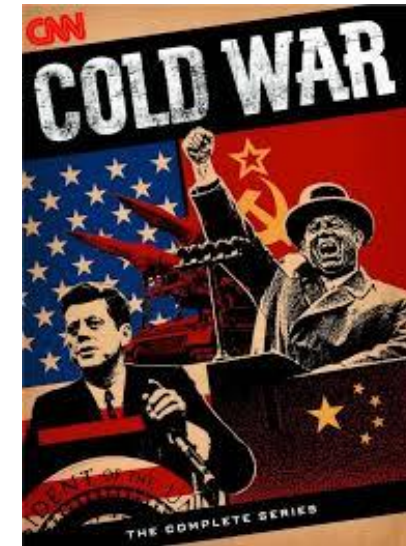
Formation of Foreign
Policy in Uzbekistan



Relations with the
Commonwealth of
Independent States

Political Situation in the 1940s-1990s

- There were two political and military blocs that opposed to one another - the USSR and the US after World War II.
- The world's peace and security system was based on the mutual balance of these two opposition systems.
- In the world, the policy of "cold war" dominated.
- All humanity lived under the threat of nuclear war.
- In the 1990s, the USSR collapsed, and the Cold War policy was abolished.
- At the turn of the 21st century, the essence of the world's development has radically changed.
- Even though these changes have taken place in the international situation, the problems and contradictions that threaten the peace of the world remain.



Advantage Position of Uzbekistan

Uzbekistan has favorable geographical and strategic capabilities in terms of establishing international relations and its prospects for development.

- The ancient Silk Road that connects the East and the West in the ancient times has crossed the territory of Uzbekistan.
- Uzbekistan, which has a geopolitical position in Central Asia, has the potential to maintain balance of power in the region, to ensure stability and strengthen cooperation.
- Uzbekistan is located in Central Asia's transport, energy, water system.
- The population of the country is superior to its neighbors in terms of population, scientific and technical and other capacities.
- Natural and climatic conditions are comfortable, have huge mineral resources and strategic materials, cultivated and arable lands that able to provide food.
- Uzbekistan has basic and modern industry, not only supplying itself with oil, gas and non-ferrous metals, but also exports them.
- Our country has world-renowned rich spiritual heritage, which has a significant place in human civilization and has the potential to influence the spiritual and political processes in the world.



Disadvantage Position of Uzbekistan

There are also factors that create difficulties for Uzbekistan in geographically-political terms. These are:

- Uzbekistan is located in a region where its collective security system has not been established in its geographical position.
- Uzbekistan is surrounded by the burden of ethnic, demographic, economic and other problems. Moreover, our country is bordered by Afghanistan.
- Uzbekistan is a country far from direct sea access and far from seaports. This situation limits the economic ties of Uzbekistan, increases shipping costs and adversely affects the competitiveness of products.
- Water resources depletion, ecological problems, and Aral tragedy are a major problematic factor for our country.

The complexity of Uzbek Foreign Policy



- The first years of independence:
 - it was crucial to set up a comprehensive foreign policy that meets the national interests of Uzbekistan
 - join the world community, establish political, diplomatic, economic, scientific and technical relations with foreign countries.
- The complexity of the matter was that in the post-Soviet era, foreign policy-making, external relations, and foreign trade were carried out by the central authorities in Moscow.
- The republics, including Uzbekistan, were closed, with no direct contact with the outside world. Therefore, our country did not have enough experience:
 - of foreign policy
 - world diplomacy
 - and lack of staff that engaged in the foreign economic activity.
- There was no educational institution in the country that would train such personnel

Formation of Foreign Policy

- President Islam Karimov defined the rules of independent foreign policy in his work "The Way of Independence and progress of Uzbekistan" and other works.
- The basic provisions of the foreign policy of Uzbekistan have been clearly defined and legalized in article 17 of the Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan.
- Laws regulating foreign trade and foreign economic relations such as "On basic principles of foreign policy of the Republic of Uzbekistan", "On foreign investments and guarantees of activity of foreign investors", "On foreign economic activity of the Republic" have been adopted. These legal bases have created a solid legal guarantee for an active and comprehensive partnership.



Main Principles

Foreign policy has been based on peace, stability and cooperation.

The main principles of the foreign policy of the Republic of Uzbekistan are as follows:

- Openness to cooperation, commitment to universal values, peace and security;
- Respect the sovereignty and equality of countries and inviolability of borders;
- not to interfere in the internal affairs of other countries;
- peaceful settlement of disputes;
- not the use of force or threat with the use of force;
- respect for human rights and freedoms;
- equality and mutual benefit in intergovernmental relations, supremacy of national interests of the state;
- develop external relations both on bilateral and multilateral basis.
- to form the unions between countries and become the member of international organizations for the sake of interest of Uzbekistan





Institutions for Foreign Affairs

- Ministries and institutions providing external links:
 - Ministry of Foreign Affairs
 - Ministry of Foreign Economic Relations
 - National Bank for Foreign Economic Activity
 - specialized foreign trade firms have been established.
- The University of World Economy and Diplomacy
- the Academy of State and Social Construction under the President of the Republic of Uzbekistan
- and other universities were formed for training specialists for foreign policy and foreign economic activity.

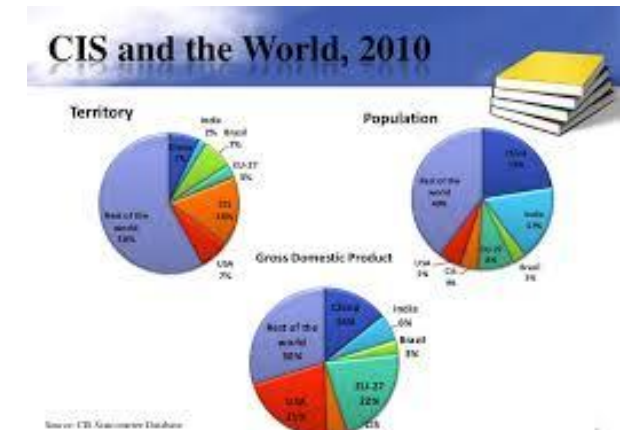


CIS

- On December 21, 1991, the presidents of Russia (B.Yeslin), Ukraine (L.Kravchuk), Belarus (S.Shushkevich), Kazakhstan (N. Nazarbayev), Uzbekistan (I.Karimov), Kyrgyzstan (Akaev), Tajikistan (R.Nabiyev), Turkmenistan (S.Niyazov), Azerbaijan (A.Mutalibov), Armenia (Ter-Petrosyan), Moldova (M.Segur) met in Almaty.
- On that day, the heads of eleven countries signed a protocol and became the founding members of the Commonwealth of Independent States in the status of "Equal Rights and Contracting High Parties." The Almaty Declaration was adopted at the session.
- On February 9, 1992, the Council of Heads of the CIS countries met in Moscow to sign an agreement on cooperation in the field of ecology and protection of the environment, the agreement on free transfer of cargoes from the territories of member states, an agreement on new single tariffs for rail and passenger transport.

CIS

- On March 20, 1992, the CIS leaders met in Kiev. It was discussed the property of the former Soviet Union, state archives, debts, the state bank and other issues. During the Kiev meeting, an agreement was signed on the protection of the borders of the states.
- On May 15, 1992, Tashkent hosted the next CIS Council of Heads of Government. The meeting discussed the financial situation and cooperation in this sphere, the use of airspace, space programs, collective security.
- In 1991-1999 there were about 25 Councils of Heads of CIS, where about 1,300 economic, social, military, political, organizational and general issues were discussed and relevant documents were signed.
- In Sochi, under the chairmanship of the President of the Russian Federation, a meeting of the Council of Heads of State of the Commonwealth of Independent States was held on October 11, 2017.
- Presidents of Russia, Azerbaijan, Armenia, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Moldova, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Uzbekistan and Prime Minister of Kyrgyzstan attended the summit.



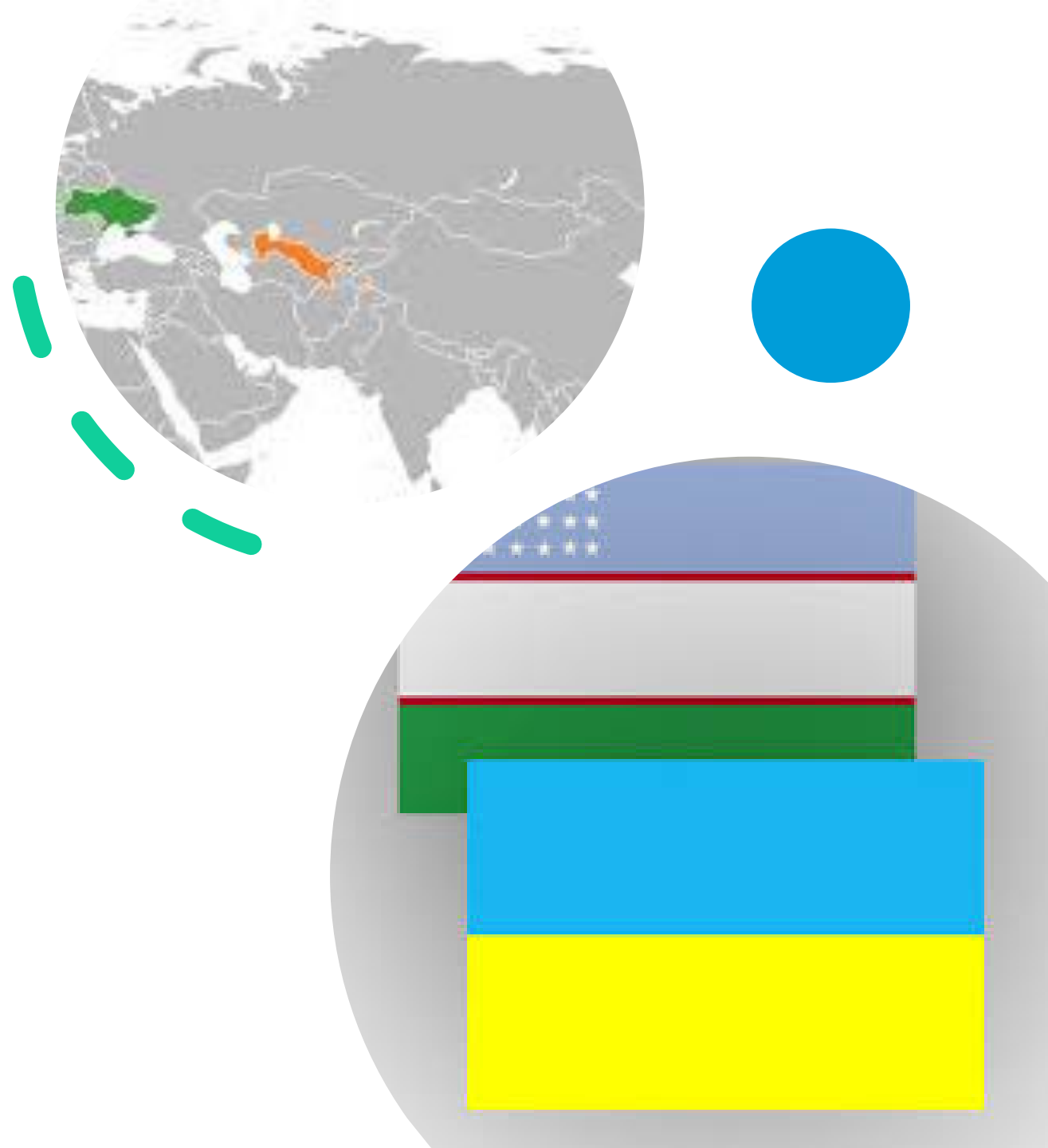


Uzbekistan-Russia

- On May 30, 1992, during the state visit of the Uzbek delegation headed by I. Karimov, an agreement on the bases of intergovernmental relations, friendship and cooperation between the Republic of Uzbekistan and the Russian Federation was signed. The contract has laid a legal foundation for establishing and developing multifaceted cooperation between two countries. Diplomatic relations between two countries were established, embassies were opened.
- On June 16, 2004, the Republic of Uzbekistan and the Russian Federation signed a strategic partnership agreement. It consists of 15 articles that will serve as a solid foundation for strategic partnerships to ensure mutual security, counter global threats, and expand cooperation in political, economic, and humanitarian spheres.
- President of Uzbekistan Shavkat Mirziyoyev made a state visit to Russia on 4-5 April 2017 on the invitation of Russian President Vladimir Putin.
- During the period 1991-2024, there were 34 high-level visits between the two countries.
- The legal framework between Uzbekistan and Russia consists of over 370 documents.
- There has been a steady increase in quantitative indicators of trade, economic, and investment cooperation between Uzbekistan and Russia. By the end of 2023, the trade turnover between the two countries exceeded \$10 billion. Currently, the investment portfolio with the Russian Federation is approximately \$35 billion.

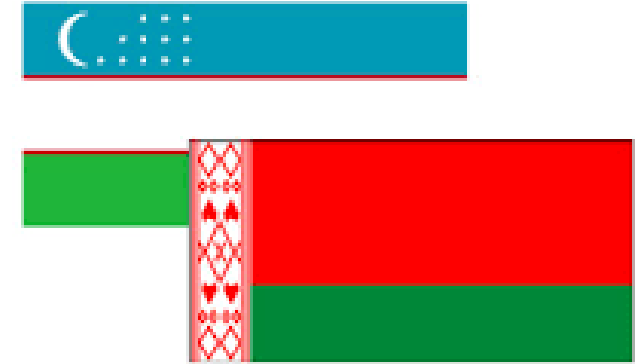
Uzbekistan-Ukraine

- The official visit of I.Karimov to Kiev in August 1992 played an important role in establishing intergovernmental relations between Uzbekistan and Ukraine.
- During the visit of Islam Karimov to Ukraine in October 1999, Uzbekistan and Ukraine signed an economic cooperation agreement for 1999-2008.
- Bilateral relations between Uzbekistan and Ukraine have a solid legal basis and consist of 142 agreements, resolutions and other documents regulating cooperation in various fields.
- At the end of 2023, the volume of bilateral trade turnover amounted to \$220 million.



Uzbekistan-Belarus

- The official visit of the Chairman of the Supreme Soviet of the Republic of Belarus S.Shushkevich to Uzbekistan on November 6, 1991 laid the foundation for interstate relations between Uzbekistan and Belarus.
- During the meeting, Islam Karimov and S. Shushkevich signed a treaty 'On the basics of interstate relations between the Republic of Uzbekistan and the Republic of Belarus'.
- On December 21-22, 1994, President of the Republic of Belarus Alexander Lukashenko made an official visit to Tashkent. During the visit, 18 documents were signed between intergovernmental bodies.
- The Republic of Uzbekistan and the Republic of Belarus signed the Agreement on economic cooperation for 2008-2017 and the Program on its execution.
- At the end of 2023, the volume of bilateral trade turnover between Uzbekistan and Belarus amounted to \$620 million.



Thank you for your attention!